



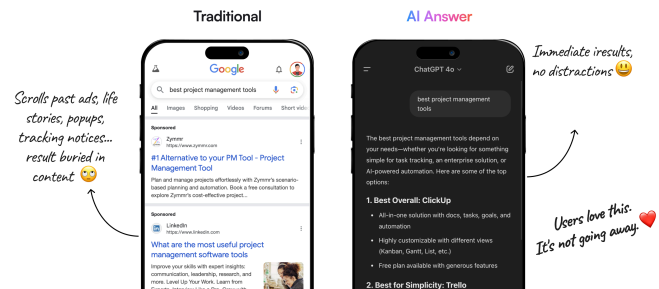
- GETTING STARTED
 - What is Writesonic?
 - Writing Style
 - Create and Manage Projects
 - Invite Team Members
 - AI Article Writer Overview
 - SEO Suite
 - How to Add a New Website Domain(using Projects)
- PRICING AND SUBSCRIPTION
 - Different subscription plans of Writesonic
 - Fair Usage Policy
- GENERATIVE ENGINE OPTIMIZATION (GEO)
 - GEO: Getting Started
 - AI Bot(Traffic) Analytics

AI Search Basics: What It Is & How It Works

What is AI Search?

If you're here, you've probably noticed something: AI is changing how people find information online. Let's understand what's actually happening under the hood.

How People Search Has Changed



Traditional Google Search:

Copy Page

- What is AI Search?
 - How People Search Has Changed
- How AI Search Actually Works (RAG)
 - Where AI Gets Its Information
 - Google's Query Fan-Out Method
 - When AI Decides to Search
- What's Different About AI Search
 - Key Differences from Traditional SEO

- User types keywords: "CRM software" (2-3 words)
- Google shows 10 blue links
- User clicks one
- You track the visit

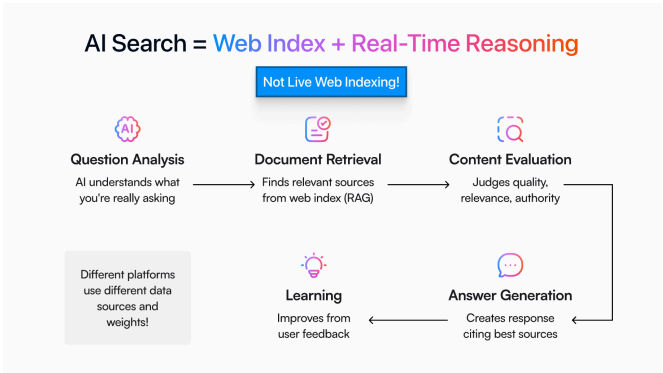
AI Search:

- User asks: "What's the best CRM for a 10-person remote marketing team that integrates with Slack?"
- AI reads multiple sources
- Creates one synthesized answer
- Maybe mentions you, maybe doesn't
- You might never know



People don't type keywords anymore. They have conversations. They provide context. They expect personalized answers.

How AI Search Actually Works (RAG)



AI search uses Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG) to provide answers.

Here's what happens step by step:

1. Question Analysis

- AI understands what you're really asking
- Identifies key entities, intent, and context
- Expands the question to capture related concepts

2. Document Retrieval

- Searches pre-built web indexes (not the live web!)
- Uses vector search to find semantically similar content
- Retrieves relevant passages from multiple sources

3. Content Evaluation

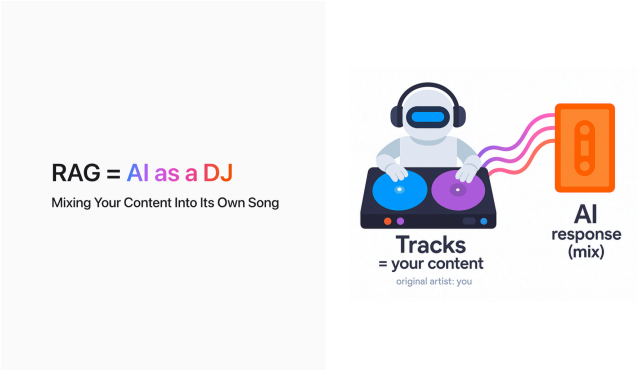
- Judges quality, relevance, and authority of sources
- Filters out low-quality or outdated information
- Prioritizes trusted domains and recent content

4. Answer Generation

- Synthesizes information from selected sources
- Creates coherent response in natural language
- Decides whether to include citations (usually doesn't)

5. Learning

- Improves from user feedback and interactions (remember the thumbs up/down buttons next to ChatGPT answers?)
- Adjusts ranking and selection algorithms
- Updates understanding of what makes good answers



Think of it like a DJ mixing tracks - AI pulls content from different sites and mixes it into one answer. But most of the time, it forgets to credit the original artists.

Where AI Gets Its Information

Critical insight: AI doesn't crawl the live web. Each platform uses different pre-built indexes:

Platform	Index Source
ChatGPT	Bing + proprietary
Perplexity	Google's index
Claude	Own crawled data
Google AI Overviews	Google's index
Gemini	Google's index

This means your brand new content won't appear immediately - it needs to be indexed first by the underlying search engine.

Google's Query Fan-Out Method



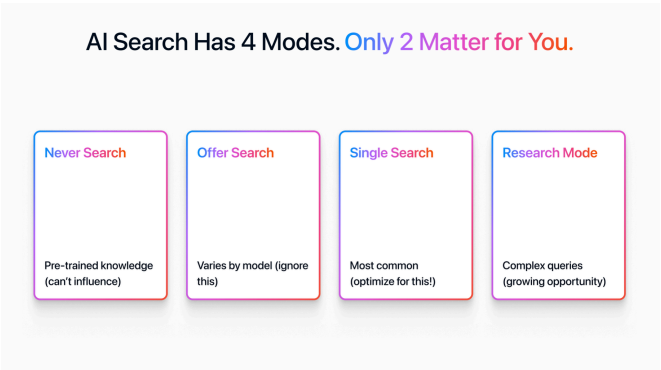
Google AI Overviews and the upcoming AI Mode do something unique - they expand one query into many.

When someone searches "best CRM software," Google AI generates 20+ related searches behind the scenes:

- CRM pricing comparison
- CRM features for small teams
- CRM integration capabilities
- CRM user reviews
- CRM setup complexity
- CRM customer support quality

Your content ranking #50 for the main term might rank #2 for "CRM API capabilities" and get included. This is why comprehensive content wins - you need to match the entire query universe, not just one keyword.

When AI Decides to Search



Based on leaked Claude documentation, AI has 4 search modes:

- 1. **Never Search** - Uses pre-trained knowledge (you can't influence this)
- 2. **Offer Search** - Varies by model (unpredictable)
- 3. **Single Search** - Most common, handles 80% of queries (your main opportunity)
- 4. **Research Mode** - Complex queries needing 2-20 searches (growing opportunity)

Focus your efforts on Single Search and Research Mode - these are where you can actually make an impact.

What's Different About AI Search

Key Differences from Traditional SEO

Aspect	Traditional SEO	AI Search (GEO)
User Input	Keywords (2-3 words)	Prompts (15-25 words)
Goal	Rank in top 10	Get mentioned at all
Competition	10 spots on page 1	Unlimited mentions possible
Traffic	Direct clicks	Brand awareness → searches
Updates	Monthly algorithm changes	Daily volatility
Trust Signals	Backlinks	Third-party mentions

Now that you understand how AI search works differently, let's learn the new vocabulary you'll need to navigate this world - from prompts to citations and everything in between.

🕒 Updated about 1 year ago

What's Next

[AI Search Vocabulary & Metrics \[Very Important\]](#) →

Did this page help you? ☐ Yes ☐ No

SEO AND CONTENT WORKFLOW

SEO Checker & Optimizer

AI Content Gap Analyzer

Keyword Researcher

AI Topic Clustering

Answer the People

AI Article Writer 6	>
Content Strategy Planner	
CONTENT CREATION	
Generate Articles in Bulk with AI Article Writer 6	
MARKETING AI AGENT	
SEO AI Agent	>
Core Features of SEO AI Agent	>
SEO AI Agent: Integrated Tools	
CHATSONIC	
Chatsonic	>
Chatsonic Google Chrome Extension	
Main Usecases of Chatsonic and Chatsonic Agent	
Chatsonic API	
INTEGRATIONS	
Publish to Wordpress.org	
Integrate with Zapier	
Connect Your Google Search Console	
Matrix Calculation for SEO Score - Chrome Extension	
HELP	
Enabling Cookies in Your Browser	
AFFILIATE PROGRAMS	
Writesonic Affiliate Program Terms and Conditions	
Chatsonic Affiliate Program Terms and Conditions	
AI DOCUMENT EDITOR	
AI Document Editor	
Ask AI	
Generate Highlights	
Download Content	
Import Content from Files, Links, and Wordpress into the AI Document Editor	
OTHER FEATURES	
Audiosonic	
Photosonic	
Plagiarism Checker	
AI Text Humanizer	
CREATE CONTENT	
Dynamic Content Creation	
Existing Templates	
REWRITER AND REPHRASER	
Content Rewriter	
BULK GENERATOR	
Bulk Generator Overview	
SUBSCRIPTION MANAGEMENT	
Navigating Subscription Payment Choices	
What if I run out of credits before renewal?	
Can I Change My Subscription Plan?	
A Comprehensive Guide to Cancelling Your Subscription	

Switching Between Monthly and Annual Billing
Understanding Subscription Cancellation Mid-Cycle
Using Your Subscription on Multiple Devices
Understanding Credit Renewal and Usage

ACCOUNT HELP

Accessing the API Dashboard: A Quick Guide
Adding a Team Member to Writesonic
Removing a Team Member from Writesonic
Understanding Credit Expiration and Renewal
Removing Chatsonic/Writesonic Chrome Extension
Accessing History on Writesonic
Navigating Chatsonic History
How to Access Older Templates in Writesonic
How to Download Invoices and Update Payment Methods
Switching to Team Account
Team Management with Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

